Housing Authority of the City of College Park

Board Minutes

Regular Monthly Meeting

Teleconference

September 23, 2021

Present:

Chairperson, Arelis Perez;
Vice Chairperson, Robert Catlin;
Commissioners, Theresa Keeler, Betsy Lynn, and James McFadden
Executive Director, Michelle Johnson;
Attick Towers Property Manager, Cheryl Gleason;
Guest, Sama Elhdad, Student of University of Maryland

I. Roll Call:

Ms. Perez opened the meeting at 10:03 a.m. All Commissioners were present.

II. Agenda Changes:

The Board reviewed/discussed the agenda. Ms. Johnson requested that Repositioning, Environmental Report, RFP Plumbing, ROSS Grant, and T-Mobile be added to the agenda under old business. A motion was made by Mr. McFadden and seconded by Mr. Catlin to approve the agenda, as amended. Robert Catlin, Theresa Keeler, Betsy Lynn, James McFadden, and Arelis Perez voted for the motion. The motion was unanimously approved by a vote of 5-0.

III. Comments-Resident Council:

None.

IV. Comments-Tenants and General Public:

Ms. Lynn discussed having a roach infestation in her unit. Ms. Johnson noted she will have Ms. Lynn's unit and the surrounding units above and next to hers, baited and treated.

Ms. Sama Elhdad introduced herself. She is a student at the University of Maryland. She is representing the Rawlings Undergraduate Leadership Fellows Program. Ms. Elhdad noted that the group is working on affordable housing in College Park, MD. She noted she will be attending the meeting as an observer only, to learn about some of the needs of College Park residents.

V. Chairman's Report:

Ms. Perez discussed several issues, i.e.

- ACOP: Continuing to work on the ACOP pages 247-571. Planned to be completed by next week to turn over the questions, to be discussed at a special meeting, to be scheduled.

- Vote: Suggestion for Commissioners to consider voting for Marshall J. Parham-Greene for Senior Vice President of NAHRO

- Atick Towers 50-year anniversary: Attick Towers opened on April 30, 1972. Board recommended the HAACP sponsor a 50-year Anniversary celebration on April 30, 2022.

- Funding: College Park received federal funding of $22 million. The Board recommended funding could be solicited from the City to assist Attick Towers, the only senior public housing in the city of College Park.

- New City manager: College Park has hired a new city manager, as of September 27, 2021. The city manager's name is Kenneth (Kenny) Young.

- Non-Profit: Ms. Perez discussed various non-profit organizations and events, i.e., Exploration on Aging, Quarter Conversation, Hyattsville Aging in Place, Helping Hands in University Park, Neighbors Helping Neighbors, College Park Affordable Housing Coalition, Aviation Museum, and College Park Hispanic month.

VI. Review and Approval of Financial Report:

The Board reviewed/discussed the Housing Authority financial reports (check registry, reconciliation summary, bank accounts, and unaudited accountant report) of July 31, 2021, and August 31, 2021. A motion was made by Ms. Lynn and seconded by Mr. Catlin to approve the financial reports of 7/31/2021, and 8/31/2021, as submitted. Robert Catlin, Theresa Keeler, Betsy Lynn, James McFadden, and Arelis Perez voted for the motion. The motion was unanimously approved by a vote of 5-0.

VII. Decision & Approval of Minutes from the Regular Monthly meeting held on July 22, 2021:

The Board reviewed/discussed the minutes from the regular monthly meeting held on July 22, 2021. A motion was made by Mr. McFadden and seconded by Mr. Catlin to approve the regular monthly meeting minutes from July 22, 2021, as submitted. Robert Catlin, Theresa Keeler, Betsy Lynn, James McFadden, and Arelis Perez voted for the motion. The motion was unanimously approved by a vote of 5-0.

VIII. Executive Directors Report:

Ms. Johnson discussed the following issues, i.e.

1) Agency/Annual Plan Review: Restoration 2021-2 Resolution: The Board reviewed/discussed the Restoration 2021-2 Resolution. There were several grammatical corrections. A motion was made by Ms. Perez and seconded by Mr. Catlin to approve the Resolution 2021-2, as amended. Robert Catlin. Betsy Lynn, Theresa Keeler, James McFadden, and Arelis Perez voted for the motion. The motion was unanimously approved by a vote of 5-0.

2) Resident Rights Letter: There will be a meeting scheduled for October 6, 2021. There will be two meetings scheduled at 11:00 a.m. and 4:30 p.m. Ms. Johnson encourages all Commissioners be present at both meetings. She also requested that the residents of Attick Towers be present at both meetings. There will be a Korean interpreter at the meeting.

3) Update Dual Pipe RFP: An RFP was issued on June 1, 2021 – August 10. 2021. There were several applicants. RSC Electrical Contractors, Inc. submitted a proposal for $134,860. The proposal was accepted and awarded to RSC Electrical Contractors, Inc. It was noted that the emergency natural disaster fund award was $146 K.

4) ROSS Coordinator: Ms. Johnson and Ms. Keeler are working together to review applicants for the ROSS Coordinator. There are 261 applicants. Applicants are being thoroughly vetted and being narrowed down.

5) T-Mobile: Crown House Castle on behalf of T-Mobile are investigating the installation of wireless services in the Washington/Baltimore area. Crown House Castle has submitted an application to Prince George's County soliciting the installation of their services within the public right of way within College Park.

IX. Old Business:

1) Update on Evictions: There are two residents in eviction. One resident is seeking an extension, the eviction is currently moving forward. The second resident has received her 30-day notice, and the eviction procedures will move forward.

2) Update on Water Savings Inc.: On hold

3) Waste Water Testing: Testing is currently being performed. The latest results are negative Covid results at Attick Towers

4) Troubled Tenant: Being investigated

5) Booster/Flu shot: Booster shots scheduled for October.

6) Resident Cleaner: Doing a wonderful job.

7) Update (CDBG) Community Development Block Grant: Reapply in October.

8) Vending Machines: On hold

9) Free HUD Training: Reviewed/discussed

10) Security: Progressive Security terminated. Lt. Corbin is on duty from 9 a.m. – 5 p.m.

11) Parking Lot: Need to have a plan to submit to Maryland Historical Trust.

12) Vacant Units: 20 vacant units being restored. 11 applicants approved from social services. The goal is to have all the units completed by the end of November.

13) Bond Bill: No update

14) ITT: No update

15) Leak in Community Room: Insurance claim has been paid. The repairs are scheduled to be completed.

16) 2020 Capital Fund: Finalizing the application. The funds will be provided when the 5-year environmental plan has been completed and submitted to HUD.

(Ms. Keeler left the meeting at 12:55 p.m.)

X. New Business:

1) Approval of invoices over $2,000: The Board reviewed/discussed invoices from July and August over $2,000, i.e.

July:

a. Tele Plus (Maintenance): Submitted an invoice for maintenance costs for $3,064.55

b. Housing Insurance Services: Submitted an invoice for $22,317.00 and $10,397.00 for policy reimbursement.

c. Barbacane Thorton & Co.: Submitted an invoice for $2,800.00 for the audit

d. Progressive Security: Submitted an invoice for $2,628.80

e. BELFOR Property Restoration: Submitted an invoice for $12,146.00 for dining room repairs

August:

f. BELFOR Property Restoration: Submitted an invoice for $3,362.38

g. Progressive Security: Submitted an invoice for $2,628.80

h. Maintenance Supplies from Lowes: Submitted an invoice for $3,481.28

i. Progressive Security: Submitted an invoice for $2,628.80

j. TK Elevator Service Maintenance: Submitted an invoice for $2,498.60

A motion was made by Ms. Perez and seconded by Ms. Lynn to approve the payments of all the invoices submitted. Robert Catlin, Betsy Lynn, James McFadden, and Arelis Perez voted for the motion. The motion was unanimously approved by a vote of 4-0.

XI. Resident Comments:

None.

XII. Commissioner Comments:

- James McFadden: None

- Robert Catlin: Discussed the County work on Rhode Island, and Cruz Development working on building project for 33 years.

- Arelis Perez: Research AARP, Community Grants, update procurement and bylaws, special meeting in November, ED evaluation performance, Chair/Vice Chairperson re-election, and vice chairperson Robert Catlin running for District 2 City Councilman (there is no conflict of interest as vice chairperson of HACCP).

XIII. Agenda items for the next meeting…. Next Meeting: October 28, 2021:

None.

XIV. Adjournment of Regular Session:

A motion was made by Ms. Perez and seconded by Mr. McFadden to adjourn the regular monthly meeting. Robert Catlin, Betsy Lynn, James McFadden, and Arelis Perez voted for the motion. The motion was unanimously approved by a vote of 4-0. The regular monthly meeting was adjourned at 1:30 p.m.

XV. Executive Session:

None.

Arelis A. Pérez

Arelis Perez, Chairman

Michelle Johnson, Executive Director